

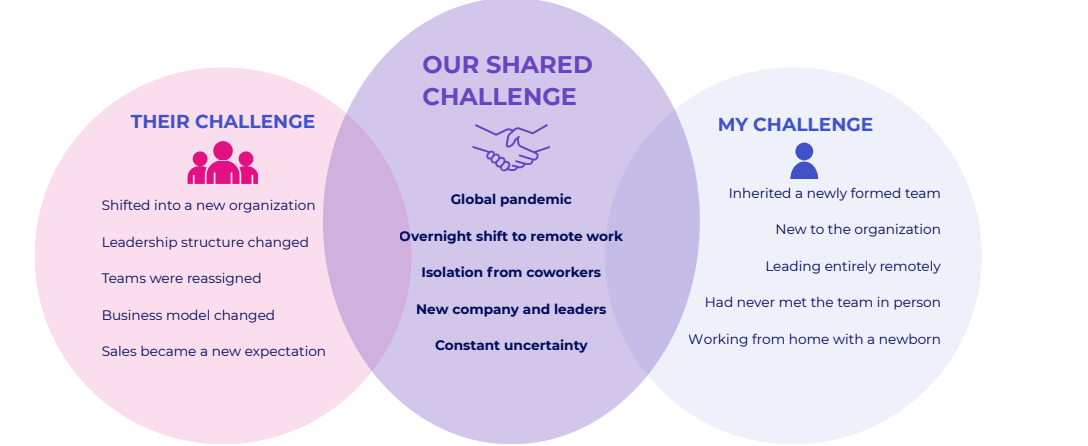
How do you turn a frightened remote support organization into a sales team?

They were afraid of COVID, afraid of losing their jobs, and afraid of selling. And now they had a new leader.

- Learning and Capability Expertise
- Transformation Experience
- Business Results

1 SHARED MOMENTS OF UNCERTAINTY

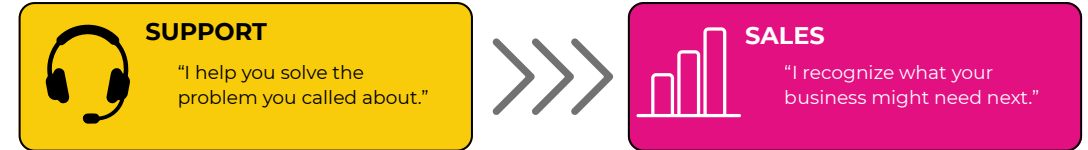
Every work group was experiencing never-seen-before circumstances.



2 A TEAM IN TRANSITION

The team was being asked to do something fundamentally different than what they had been hired to do.

The leaders were learning a new job, too. They knew how to coach operational performance, but not sales performance. Overcoming objections, evaluating sales conversations, and analyzing an account for growth opportunities were all new muscles they needed to build alongside their teams.



3 BELIEF BEFORE SKILL

So I didn't start with sales training. Before they could sell differently, they had to see themselves differently.



AT A GLANCE

- 56 employees
- 8 frontline leaders
- Newly remote work functions
- 800% performance achievement

WHY THIS STORY

This is what leading with empathy looks like when the expectations still have to change. I didn't lower the bar because people were scared; I worked to build the belief and capability they needed to reach it.

This story also demonstrates:

- Change leadership
- Sales transformation
- Capability building
- Performance coaching
- Organizational empathy

IF WE TALK, ASK ME ABOUT

- What I learned about the team before I ever asked them to sell.
- Why I decided I needed to learn their job myself.
- How "Finding the Alert" changed the emotional barrier to selling.
- When coaching stopped and accountability had to begin.
- What learning the job in under 90 days allowed me to expect from my leaders.
- The external partnership I would handle differently.

WHAT I'M PROUD OF

I got to make a difference in people's lives. Two people who didn't get the job the first time became the leaders who came next. The work I did reset expectations across the newly acquired org for what accountability could look like, without micromanaging or harsh approaches.

MY GUIDING PRINCIPLE

Accountability works better when capability comes first. Teach it. Practice is. Make the standard visible. Then hold people to it.

IF I HAD A DO-OVER

I'd manage some external partnerships differently. Earlier in my career, I sometimes let another person's behavior dictate my response. Today, when someone says something provocative, my instinct is much simpler: "What do you mean?" Curiosity gives me time to understand before I react.